

OREGON CITY COURIER

35th Year

OREGON CITY, OREGON, THURSDAY, DECEMBER 20, 1917

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LADS' KILL MATE IN SHAM BATTLE

LESLIE L'DOUX DROPS WHEN
SMALL BULLET PENE-
TRATES FOREHEAD

BOYS CONFESS TO SHERIFF

Fix Story to Tell Relatives and
Stick to It for Many Hours.
Jury Finds Verdict

Leslie La Doux, 14 years old, was instantly killed Saturday afternoon in a battle with two playmates in a field near Parkplace. Cecil Green, aged 13, and Lake Smith, 16, are held charged with the killing of the little boy, and Cecil Shaw, 8, is also said to have been a party to the crime.

On Sunday morning at an early hour, Sheriff Wilson was called to Parkplace to aid in a search for La Doux, reported lost on Grouse mountain. Sheriff Wilson immediately scouted the theory that a boy of that age would be lost and questioned his playmates. They said they had left him in the afternoon when he became ill and started back home. Later the sheriff plied the boys with questions and Cecil Green was the first to admit that they had been fighting armed with 22-caliber rifles. Green and Smith took single shot rifles, according to the story and gave the dead lad a pump gun and shielded by trees and stumps at a distance of about 60 paces, they opened fire.

The sheriff arrested the boys Sunday morning and after much questioning they finally confessed fully to Sheriff Wilson, District Attorney Gilbert Hedges and Constable D. E. Frost. LaDoux was shielded from the bullets, fired by his companions, by a tree trunk and the two against him were behind a log or stump. Shots were exchanged several times before a 22-caliber bullet pierced the center of the forehead of young LaDoux. He is said to have dropped instantly. His own gun, a single shot 22, was put back in his hand by his companions and they went home, fixing up a story to tell inquirers.

The 8-year-old Shaw had stuck to his version of the story even after the older boys had confessed. He said that he had not been near the scene of the shooting at all, but finally admitted that he had carried a ramrod for the older boys, but took no part in the shooting.

Four hours were consumed by a coroner's jury Monday night in finding a verdict in the case. Nothing materially affecting the original version of the story, based upon the confessions of the three boys who were with La Doux when he was killed, was introduced in testimony. The boys claim not to know which of them fired the fatal shot and unless District Attorney Gilbert L. Hedges decides to continue an investigation, this probably will never come out.

The story, as told Monday night by Lake Smith, Cecil Green and Cecil Shaw, bears out the statements of the last named, an 8-year-old, that he had no part in the shooting. The boys say that La Doux first proposed the battle and that he agreed to stand off the other two if they would give him the pump gun, a 22-caliber rifle. The others, taking single-shot 22-caliber rifles, ambushed themselves and the battle started. The survivors say that La Doux opened fire while one of them was sitting on a stump cleaning his gun. They also say that the fatal shot was fired while both were cleaning guns.

Mimic warfare was planned and the boys had defined what they called

FUNERAL TODAY

Boy Killed by Playmates to be Buried at Clackamas Today

Funeral services for Leslie LaDoux, killed on Saturday in a battle with playmates, will be held from the Congregational church at Parkplace this afternoon, with Rev. H. N. Smith, of Jennings Lodge, in charge. Interment will be in the Clackamas cemetery. The boy, of which the 14-year-old lad was a member, will take part in the services.

SANDY CUTS TIMBER

The lumber resources of the Sandy section are being drawn upon in the shipbuilding activities of the Pacific northwest and timbers for bowsprits and masts are being supplied to firms in Portland, Vancouver and Grays Harbor towns. Only the most select timber is being used and it is taken from the farms of B. Nelson, Beck Bros., Paul R. Meinig, James De Shazer and others in the near vicinity. R. B. Spooner of Lents, in charge of a crew of men, has several contracts to fill.

SULLIVAN IS GUILTY IN WETTLAUER CASE

MR. BUCHE FREED OF CHARGE
IN TIMBER GROVE SCHOOL
BOARD FIGHT

Spectators who packed Justice of the Peace John N. Sievers' office Tuesday and overflowed in crowds into the street heard a more or less sensational trial in the case of the state against B. Sullivan and A. F. Buche, directors of the Timber Grove school district, accused of assault and battery by the Rev. W. H. Wettlaufer, clerk of the district. A justice court jury found Mr. Sullivan guilty as charged and released Mr. Buche. Sullivan will be given sentence by the court as soon as possible.

Timber Grove school patrons came into the city in large numbers and, because of the interest taken in the case, many of them were not able to get into the court room. The trial lasted throughout the day.

It was shown that the bad blood existing in the Timber Grove district came to a head last week when the two factions prepared a contract covering the employment of Miss Florence Stromgren as teacher. Rev. Mr. Wettlaufer picked up the contract, prepared by Sullivan and his faction, just as Miss Stromgren was about to sign it. In another instant the minister was rolling on the floor with Sullivan and others taking their spite out on him. Mr. Buche, who was freed Tuesday, is said to have entered the fight when Mrs. Wettlaufer rushed to the aid of her husband. Mr. Sullivan admitted branding Mr. Wettlaufer with unbecoming titles at school board meetings. Senator Walter A. Dimick, representing Sullivan, intimated that he will appeal the case.

The Clarks school board which transacts its business in a quiet, unassuming fashion, is righteously indignant at the report that this trouble was at a Clarks meeting. Clarks and Timber Grove are near one another, it is true, but the trouble was in the Timber Grove district.

TWO FISH DAMAGE CASES PENDING ARE DISMISSED

The two remaining damage cases brought against Clackamas county by the Fish family, three members of which were injured in an automobile accident on the Pacific highway between here and New Era, in August, 1916, were dismissed last week upon motion of attorney for Frank E. Fish and his daughter, Amy. Mrs. Alice Etta Fish also sued the county and her case, tried some time ago, was decided in favor of the county. Mr. Fish asked \$100 for damages to his automobile, which is said to have rolled over a steep embankment and the girl asked \$2000 for personal injuries.

The district attorney's office won the first of the three cases by the inclusion of much evidence showing the safe condition of the road and proving that the county had not been negligent. It is said that the first victory for the county brought about the dismissal of the cases pending.

THREE ALLEGED SHIRKERS HAULED FROM ESPEE CAR

Joseph L. Danner, Philip Solem and Ivan M. Jenne were hauled from a Southern Pacific boxcar here last Thursday night and were taken to Portland for investigation as shirkers. The three were about the city most of the day. Danner said that he was dishonorably discharged from the United States army about three months ago for drunkenness. He had just returned from the Philippines. Jenne gave the officers a Portland address and at that place the lad's father stated the boy was only 19 years old. He was released. The third youth claims to be from Minnesota and says he is not yet of draft age. When they were arrested the trio had just \$2.50 as joint capital. Danner told the officers that his discharge papers from the army were stolen from him while he was drunk and that he lost the registration card issued to him at Acton, Cal.

COLONEL IS FREE

Guided Sword Returned to Prisoner Sent from Oregon City

Colonel Edward de Reymonte, formerly of Moscow, Russia, Cairo, Egypt, and Oregon City, who had been detained in Portland for two weeks pending a federal investigation, has been released. His "valet" Otto Rose, who was incarcerated with his master, was liberated also. The pair started for Mukilteo, Wash., where Reymonte's wife is alleged to be, after Reymonte had recovered his guided sword from the United States marshal. No reason for the release of the highly suspicious characters has been given.

The Courier, The Oregon farmer and a merchandise order, all for \$1.00. The greatest bargain offer ever made by a Clackamas county newspaper.

STORM'S DAMAGES ESTIMATED GREAT

W. V. S. LINES SUFFER. MOLLALA CUT OFF BY HIGH
WATER AND ROADS

AFFECTS MILLS AND PLANTS

Rainfall Unprecedented and Rivers
Overflow Banks. Bridges Go
Out in High Water

An appraisal of the total damage done during the recent heavy rain storm that raged through the Willamette Valley is impossible, but a forecast, based upon advices from many affected parts of Clackamas county, indicates that the damage here will be heavier than for several years previous.

Thus far one of the great inconveniences resulting from the storm was the closing of the Clackamas river bridge beyond Parkplace, making travel to the north route over the west side or by way of Baker's bridge. A pier so badly washed by the high water in the Clackamas that the bridge was considered unsafe is the immediate cause of the closing.

During the 24 hours ending here yesterday morning and marking the most serious part of the storm, the Willamette river had raised approximately four feet and 4.41 inches of rain had fallen. Drain outlets were raging torrents. The Clackamas, at the rapids, overflowed and inundated a great area of territory. Gladstone was threatened with a complete immersion on Wednesday when the water got so high as to flood the streets and the floors of several store-rooms, including the postoffice.

The Upper Clackamas river is higher than it has ever known to be and with a continuation of the rainfall damage to the Willamette Valley Southern lines is estimated at \$10,000, caused by several slides and wash outs. Near Monitor aid in other places the track is washed away and crews are busy elsewhere removing slides from the track. President Dimick is in charge personally. W. V. S. service is paralyzed.

Many families will either flee or endanger their lives. The Big Sandy river is raging and residents there say that both the Sandy and the Salmon rivers are raised to a higher level than ever before. The dam near Marmot broke some time ago, causing the loss of thousands of ties that had been boomed. Both rivers have overflowed and are filled with driftwood.

An old bridge near Beaver Creek, near the residence of Charles Rider, went crashing down the creek some time early Wednesday morning and is said to be a complete loss. With the exception of the damage to the Clackamas river bridge this is perhaps the most serious loss to property in the county. Other bridges are threatened and may go out before the end of the week, even though the rainfall does let up. The water will continue to rise, it is said, for several days. A depth of nearly 20 feet is predicted for the Willamette at Oregon City by tomorrow. The extent of the damage at the Clackamas river bridge cannot be definitely known until Roadmaster Roots makes an official survey. Much damage to private property has resulted at the Clackamas rapids, where the water is far out of the banks.

Steel towers which carry transmission lines from the power stations of the P. R. L. & P. Co. on the Clackamas are in many instances attacked by raging waters, which are gradually washing away the foundations of these great structures. Working crews have been endeavoring to reinforce the tower bases and if this is found to be impossible some sort of rigging will be made to prevent the lines from going down.

The many small streams that feed the Clackamas, Bull Run, Sandy, Johnson Creek and others are full and running over and the unusual water supply in turn fills the larger streams and causes a general inundation of property. On the upper Clackamas the water is said to be six feet higher than it has ever before been known. It came up fast and is still rising rapidly.

Trouble at the south fork intake has shut Oregon City's water power off and the city is using the reservoir supply. The elevator is out of commission as a result. Property has been damaged throughout the city and streets in many cases are not usable.

In Oregon City the damage has been largely in the loss of many small boats moored to the banks of the river. On Tuesday night there was a general scurrying of fishermen to get their boats and shelters to high ground lest they wash completely away. With a fall of 4.41 inches of water in 24 hours ending Wednesday morning there is no telling what may happen if such should continue. This fall represents approximately one-tenth of the to-

(Continued on Page 8)

E. G. WAIT KILLED IN ACCIDENT AT CANBY

MAN TUGS AT SPEEDER TOO
LONG AND IS GROUND
BENEATH WHEELS

FEDERAL BOARD'S REPORT AT HAND

IT CHARGES CROWN-WIL-
METTE WITH CONTINUA-
TION OF TROUBLES

In an attempt to prevent the derailment of an approaching Southern Pacific train near Canby on Saturday night, E. G. Wait, a section hand, lost his life while he was tugging to get a gasoline speeder, upon which he had been riding, off the track. Wait and two other men were riding on the speeder when they saw the oncoming train. The other two men left the car and saved themselves while Wait remained with the machine to get it off the tracks before the train should collide with it.

Roy Loomis, a brakeman on the train, was riding on the pilot when the engine hit the speeder. He was painfully injured. The engine crew took Loomis to Portland and he was removed to his home. Wait lived with his family at Canby.

It is reported that Wait was operating the speeder without lights, and that the train could not well have prevented the accident. He had just started to take the speeder off the track unaided when the train crashed into him. He is said to have died almost instantly.

A coroner's jury sitting in the case on Monday returned a verdict covering accidental death. Testimony at the hearing was that Wait had been dragged 170 feet beneath the engine when it struck a gasoline speeder which he was attempting to get off the track. The speeder was taken double that distance. Alex Schwabauer and William Krueger, who had been on the speeder just before the train struck it, testified that all three thought the oncoming train was going to turn into a switch, and when they discovered their mistake Krueger and Schwabauer left the gas car. Wait tugged at it and in a moment was beneath the engine wheels.

Mr. Wait's body was buried at Canby Monday afternoon from the home in which the dead man's wife is confined as an invalid. Interment was in Zion cemetery at Canby. The jury assembled by Acting Coroner John N. Sievers was composed of L. H. Wang, Andrew Koehler, C. L. Bates, George F. Meels, D. R. Dimick and A. H. Knight.

BUDGET MEETING

The annual county budget meeting is to be held at the court house in Oregon City on Saturday beginning at 10 a. m. Be on hand, if you are a taxpayer, and approve or disapprove of the county court's methods of spending your tax money.

PAY YOUR SUB AT ONCE AND GET GREAT VALUE

Only four more days! What are YOU going to do about it?

On Monday, the day before Christmas, The Courier's great subscription offer ends. Until Monday night any person subscribing to The Courier will be presented, free of cost, with a merchandise order for 25 cents, exchangeable for merchandise at any store in Oregon City, and one year's subscription to The Courier for a full year—all for \$1.00.

Can you beat it?

No newspaper has duplicated The Courier's offer simply because it can't be done. The people of Clackamas county have appreciated the offer, too, because the demand for subscriptions in this office has been unprecedented. We have issued scores of merchandise orders and entered scores of subscriptions. Get your's today. Tuesday will be too late.

For \$1.00 paid before Monday night you get The Courier and the Oregon Farmer for a full year and a merchandise order valued at 25 cents.

RED CROSS DRIVE GOES ON IN SPITE OF STORM

Clackamas county's drive for Red Cross memberships has been going on for several days and such good work has been done in all parts of the county that O. D. Eby, general chairman, predicts that the county's quota will be raised this week without difficulty. Throughout the day Tuesday groups of solicitors worked in Oregon City and made a great record in spite of the terrific storm that has been raging. It seems that half the people in the city today are wearing Red Cross buttons.

Meetings have already been held in many sections of the county and others were held last night at various points, including Meadowbrook, Oak Lawn, Evergreen, Canby and Rock Creek. A meeting will be held on Friday afternoon at the Mountain road school house.

FEDERAL BOARD'S REPORT AT HAND

IT CHARGES CROWN-WIL-
METTE WITH CONTINUA-
TION OF TROUBLES

REVIEW OF LOCAL ACTIONS

State Board Reports to Governor.
Presidential Commission De-
fines Its Position

The report of the federal mediation commission appointed by President Wilson to investigate strikes on the west coast yesterday was made public insofar as it concerns the strike of paper mill employees in Oregon City. The commission, headed by Secretary of Labor Wilson, investigated local strike conditions and heard arguments on both sides of the questions when it was in Portland recently. The commission admits its failure to handle the situation and charges the failure to the attitude of the Crown-Willamette Paper Co., which has maintained its position against the arbitration of questions brought up by the unions.

Governor Withycombe's state mediation committee, comprising Judge J. U. Campbell, Judge H. S. Anderson and District Attorney Gilbert L. Hedges has already submitted a detailed report to the governor, but admits that it has done nothing toward a settlement of the difficulty.

The federal commission's report says:

"The Crown Willamette Paper company is the owner of three paper mills in the states of Oregon and Washington. At the end of October a strike was declared against the company. Charged with the duty of labor adjustment in war industries, the president's mediation commission could not direct a settlement of a strike in paper mills. The good offices of the commission were, however, enlisted towards a mediation of the difficulties.

"Purely as a mediator for the commission sought to effect an adjustment, because labor difficulties in times of war have their influence beyond an immediate industry affected. This is true particularly of an industry such as the Crown Willamette Paper company, located in one of the most active war industries area and exercising a close influence upon the general labor contentment so essential to the effective prosecution of the war.

"The representatives of the strikers submitted their side of the controversy to the commission with the unreserved offer to be bound by whatever settlement the commission should make and to be so bound for the period of the war. The manager of the company appeared before the commission at its request. After a full discussion the sum and substance of his attitude was 'nothing to arbitrate.' The commission thereupon took the matter up with the controlling authorities of the company in San Francisco. After a detailed statement of the facts by the commission, setting forth the present unsatisfactory labor conditions considered from the point of view of the company as well as the government, the company courteously, but firmly, rejected the tender of service made by the president's mediation commission.

"At any time an attitude of 'nothing to arbitrate' is an attitude at variance with the modern spirit in industry. In view of the influence that such an attitude may have upon labor conditions in neighboring war industries, much more so is this true in time of war. The present attitude of the Crown Willamette Paper company is therefore a matter of such public concern that the president's mediation commission deems it a duty briefly to set forth the essential facts so that the public interest at stake may be safeguarded by an informed public opinion.

"The three chief demands of the men were," the statement says, "(1) an increase in the wage scale to meet the increased cost of living, (2) an agreement on the part of the company not to discriminate against employees because of trade union affiliation, and (3) the establishment of a workers' committee by which grievances could be taken up collectively through the committee with the management."

"The management declined to discuss these proposals. The management further rejected the proposal of the employees that the dispute be submitted to arbitration," the statement says.

"The justice of one of the demands, the manager in part admitted before the president's mediation commission," the report says. "He admitted that the company's wage scale was at least in some instances too low."

It is a fact that little business grows to big business, and the route is smoother, more easily traveled, when you pave the way by the use of printer's ink through Courier advertising and Courier job printing.

INCOME TAX MAN IS TO COME TO COUNTY

WILL CONFER WITH 1104 WHO
WILL PROBABLY HAVE TO
PAY FOR INCOMES

GREAT OLD NOME IS ONLY MEMORY

PANNED DRY OF GOLD ITS
ONCE BIG POPULATION IS
LEAVING THE TOWN

In a communication received by The Courier, Collector of Internal Revenue Milton A. Miller, announces that a federal income tax officer will be sent into this county on February 2, and will be here until February 23, 1918. He will have his office in the court house, Oregon City, and will be there every day ready and willing to help persons subject to the income tax to make out their returns without any cost to them for his services.

How many income-tax payers will there be in Clackamas county? If you can guess how many married persons living with wife or husband will have net incomes of \$2,000 or over this year, then you know. The collector of internal revenue estimates that there will be 1104 taxpayers in Clackamas county.

Returns of income for the year 1917 must be made on forms provided for the purpose before March 1, 1918. Because a good many people don't understand the law and won't know how to make out their returns, the government is sending in this expert to make himself known to the taxpayers. If you do not make returns as required before March 1, you may have to pay a penalty ranging from \$20 to \$1,000, pay a fine or go to jail. So if you don't want to take chances on going to jail, you had better call on the income tax man. If you are not sure about being subject to the tax, better ask him and make sure. Whether you see the income tax man or not, you must make return if subject to tax. Of course, persons resident in other counties may, if they want to, come and see the income tax man, who will be at the county seat on the dates above mentioned.

The collector suggests that everybody start figuring up now his income and expenses so as to be ready with the figures when the expert arrives. Expenses, however, don't mean family expenses, money used to pay off the principal of a debt, new machinery, buildings, or anything like that. They mean what you spend in making your money—interest, taxes paid, hired help, amount paid for goods sold, seed, stock bought for feeding, rent (except for your dwelling), etc. Income includes about every dollar you get.

But the ocean was as glassy as a duck pond this summer morning and everybody could land—everybody that would come down with \$2.50.

And here was a funny one I never did get the straight of. My passage was free both ways, while my roommate was assessed \$2.50. From a food conservation view the steamship company might better have loaded the whole bunch, for it was mean family expenses, money used to pay off the principal of a debt, new machinery, buildings, or anything like that. They mean what you spend in making your money—interest, taxes paid, hired help, amount paid for goods sold, seed, stock bought for feeding, rent (except for your dwelling), etc. Income includes about every dollar you get.

The Live Wires of the Commercial club Tuesday voted to approve the county budget draft as submitted by the county court, with the exception of the item covering the establishment of the county infirmary. This and other features of the budget were debated by the Live Wires at their previous meeting, and in the face of a majority objection in the county court and elsewhere against the poor farm, the Wires took no action on the item. The approval voted Tuesday includes items for the hire of the county agent and for the purchase of an automobile for the school supervisor.

The local paper mills reported at the meeting that they would urge every man in their employ to join the Red Cross this week, and would advance the money for membership, with the understanding that it should come out of their wages at the end of the month. The Wires will not meet again until Tuesday, January 8.

LIVE WIRES HOLD SHORT, SWEET TUESDAY SESSION

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NEGRO HAS WHISKY Sheriff Wilson Nabs Dark Skinned Bootlegger with Heavy Case

A. Hankins, 47-year-old negro, was arrested here this morning by Sheriff Wilson and Deputy H. Hughes as he was waiting for a street car to Portland. A suitcase carried by the man contained eight quarts of whisky, supposedly from California. Hankins alighted from a north bound Southern Pacific train at 9:30 this morning and made tracks for the street car. He claims to have been paid \$1.00 by a porter on the train to get off here with the suitcase and carry it in to Portland, where he was to deliver it to the porter again at the Union depot. He is held in the county jail.

ELLIOTT AND SINCLAIR PAY Default in Payment on Land Brings Judgment from Court

Through the default of E. D. Elliott and S. F. Sinclair, a decree of foreclosure was issued last week by Judge Campbell in favor of the Glenmorrie company, barring the two from any claim to 3 1/2 acres of land in Glenmorrie. The company contracted to sell block 1, Glenmorrie, to Elliott and Sinclair in 1912, at a price of \$3125. When they failed to make stipulated payments, suit was brought against them and they were allowed until December 6 to settle their obligation. Again defaulting, the decree of foreclosure was issued.

GREAT OLD NOME IS ONLY MEMORY

PANNED DRY OF GOLD ITS
ONCE BIG POPULATION IS
LEAVING THE TOWN

400 PEOPLE, 300 DOGS LEFT

Nome, Unlike Others, is a Summer
Camp. Dredges and Hydraulics
Replace Nugget Pans

(M. J. Brown)

"God goes out on the last boat and he doesn't come back until spring" is the saying in Nome. And I judged that pretty nearly everyone went outside with him this year. In 1910 Nome had 3000 people. This winter 400 white men and 300 dogs will put in the long winter and wait for God and the first boat to come in from Seattle next spring, and I figure that in two years more there will be more dogs than men in the once famous gold city.

I was out of my stateroom at four in the morning to get a first glimpse of gold-famous Nome. Our ship was anchored about two miles out, and passengers are lighter-ened in—that is, when the weather permits. Sometimes for days storms sweep across the Bering sea and blow the water into such heaps that it is impossible to land. Then the passengers console themselves in singing that ever-popular song along the Bering sea, "Oh, Why is the Ocean So Close to the Shore?"

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WESLEY MILLIKEN AND MISS BUCKLES MARRIED

Wesley D. Milliken, oldest son of Dr. W. T. Milliken, pastor of the First Baptist church, was married by his father Sunday to Miss Bernice E. Buckles, daughter of Mr. and Mrs. A. B. Buckles. The young man is a corporal in the 6th company, coast artillery, stationed at Fort Stevens, and his bride is a popular young woman. Her father, A. B. Buckles, is a member of the city council, representing the second ward. The marriage, which took place at the home of the bride's parents, is a culmination of a romance which began at the Oregon City high school, where both young people were students. Mrs. Milliken will remain at home for the time being, and her husband has reported back to his company at Fort Stevens.

GIRL IS INJURED Ruth Zanders Knocked Down by Auto During Heavy Storm

Ruth Zanders, sister of a Milwaukee banker, was painfully bruised Tuesday when she was knocked down by an automobile. Pushing through a blinding storm with an umbrella in front of her, the young woman did not see the machine coming and the rain is supposed to have obscured the vision of the driver. The full extent of Miss Zander's injuries has not been ascertained, but it is known by her friends that they will not result seriously.

County Clerk Harrington announces receipt of license forms for the use and possession of powder and explosives. All who apply for such licenses must appear in person, Miss Harrington advises.